

In Power But Not **IN CONTROL**

The No. 2 in various Congress governments for 17 years, Rosaiah is yet to come to grips with power despite being chief minister for five months now

| By Amarnath K. Menon |

Like the vice-captain in a team, K. Rosaiah is among the breed of politicians who are comfortable being No. 2 and are never suited to be skipper. He took office under exceptional circumstances within hours after his formidable predecessor Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy died in a helicopter crash on September 3 last year. Since then he has braved several storms even as he appeared to steer what could at best be termed a tottering administration. Five months into his Government now, doubts continue to crop up whether the 76-year-old, who has for long played second fiddle as the state's finance minister, will emerge from the many sectarian and sub-regional polemics and politics that afflict both Andhra Pradesh as well as his party.

The dash and dynamism symbolic of his predecessor's style of governance is missing. Rosaiah is acutely conscious of this but not unduly worried because, perhaps, he thinks that it is the Congress's problem more than his own. The party, of course, is to blame. Caught in a bitter inner party feud, the Congress at first played for time as it appeared to be rattled by a sustained campaign to anoint Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy, a first-time MP and son of his predecessor. It took three months to formally get Rosaiah selected as legislature party leader and confirm him as chief minister. Now, it is costing the

